DAMON VERSAGGI

DESIGN DIRECTOR | AI, INTERACTIVE SYSTEMS & CREATIVE TECHNOLOGY

Brooklyn, NY | damon@scrappymeals.com | 718.541.9062 | scrappymeals.com/rga | linkedin.com/in/damonversaggi

PROFILE

Creative technology and design leader who turns emerging technology into systems people can understand, use and feel. Nearly 20 years across real-time 3D, product, AI, interfaces, XR/AR, broadcast, live experiences and multidisciplinary design. Known for entering ambiguous environments without established conventions, defining the experience, prototyping the system, aligning technical and creative teams, and raising the quality bar through the work itself.

SELECTED IMPACT

AI-NATIVE PRODUCT
Created Fridgie Smalls, an AI recipe product used by ~20,000 users; redesigned its AI workflow to cut input tokens 72%, reduce tokens per call 40%, and improve response time by ~2 seconds.

DESIGN SYSTEMS IN REAL TIME
Built and directed dynamic graphics and interactive systems for ESPN, CNN, CBS, FOX, NBC, Amazon Prime Sports, SNY and major live events where content, data and visual behavior adapt in real time.

DESIGN + R&D
At Vizrt, worked between designers, clients, sales, engineering and R&D; traveled to Norway to bring field insight into future software development and trained close to 1,000 artists/operators.

CLIENT LEADERSHIP
Led demonstrations, technical conversations, training, creative direction and high-stakes delivery for enterprise media clients while translating complex systems into clear creative possibilities.

EXPERIENCE

SCRAPPY MEALS XR / FRIDGIE SMALLS | Founder & Design / Creative Technology Lead **2016-Present**

- Created and evolved Fridgie Smalls from concept to shipped AI product, defining product behavior, interaction patterns, AI workflows, visual direction, responsive web experience and technical architecture.
- Designed agentic and generative product experiences around fridge inventory, dietary constraints, substitutions, cuisine, budget and cooking intent - translating model capability into a usable consumer interface rather than treating AI as a content shortcut.
- Built prototypes and production experiences directly with code and models using OpenAI APIs, Vercel, Hono, Railway, MCP, Web Speech API, WebXR, Three.js/real-time 3D and modern web tooling.
- Developed Scrappy Meals XR, The Metacheese immersive culinary learning world, 3D restaurant/menu experiences and interactive food-tech concepts spanning brand, product, storytelling, education and emerging interfaces.
- Created and led an international internship cohort of 16 students; mentored multidisciplinary contributors across creative, technical and product work while establishing briefs, critique and delivery standards.

DAMON VERSAGGI CONSULTING / GIRRAPHIC | Creative Technology Director / Senior Graphics Consultant **2015-Present**

- Lead concept-to-execution work across real-time design, AR/XR, interfaces and live production for Amazon Prime Sports, ESPN, NBC, YES Network, Chicago Cubs/Marquee Sports Network, Lockheed Martin and other clients.
- Directed AR and real-time sports experiences including Amazon Prime Yankees graphics and ESPN Around the Horn, connecting design, motion, data, technical constraints and live operational behavior.
- Move between client strategy, art direction, prototyping, implementation, troubleshooting and delivery - often inside high-pressure environments where the solution and workflow must be invented simultaneously.

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

VIZRT | Production Manager / Art Director - Creative Services **2004-2008**

- Helped establish real-time 3D graphics workflows for major broadcasters and sports networks, using Vizrt as a design and production platform before real-time engines became standard creative infrastructure.
- Led creative services, demos, technical support and training for ESPN, CNN, CBS, FOX, Bloomberg, HBO, Turner Sports, The Weather Channel, SNY and international clients; trained close to 1,000 artists and operators.
- Worked directly with research and development in Norway to translate client and designer needs into product feedback for future versions of the software, bridging field usage, creative ambition and engineering reality.
- Built and led a five-person demo/training function, mentored instructors and interns, and partnered with sales, IT, R&D and client teams to improve adoption and creative quality.
- Resolved a critical on-air system failure roughly one hour before an NBA Finals tip-off by diagnosing and swapping control hardware, protecting a high-value live broadcast and approximately $500K in advertising exposure.

SPORTSNET NEW YORK (SNY) | Production Manager / Creative-Technical Lead **2008-2012**

- Held a custom cross-functional role spanning production leadership and art direction; redesigned NY Mets in-game and pre/post-game productions and Citi Field graphics while improving real-time workflow across the network.
- Guided and trained production, newsroom and operations teams on graphics systems, integrating real-time design workflows with sponsorship, marketing and live editorial needs.

TRIBUNE MEDIA / PIX11 | Production Manager **2012-2015**

- Led replacement and operation of the on-air graphics system for PIX11 and affiliates, connecting Art, Technology and News teams while supporting a 24-hour live environment.
- Developed interactive election graphics, maintained critical production infrastructure and served as creative-production liaison across departments.

DICK CLARK PRODUCTIONS | Lead Graphics Consultant - New Year's Rockin' Eve **2011-Present**

- Lead real-time graphics operations for New Year’s Rockin’ Eve, creating countdown systems, managing last-minute content and sponsorship changes, staffing operators and maintaining quality under live national-broadcast pressure.

DESIGN LEADERSHIP & CAPABILITIES

Design: Creative direction, art direction, product design, UX/UI, interaction design, visual systems, motion, real-time graphics, prototyping, storytelling, critique, design quality and systems thinking

AI / Emerging Technology: Generative AI, agentic experiences, LLM workflows, OpenAI APIs, MCP, AI-assisted production, adaptive interfaces, WebXR, AR/XR, real-time 3D, Unreal Engine, Three.js

Tools: Adobe Creative Cloud, Figma, Blender, Unreal Engine, Vizrt, Procreate, Gravity Sketch, Vercel, Railway, GitHub, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Python fundamentals

Leadership: Multidisciplinary team leadership, client leadership, mentoring, design critique, technical translation, R&D collaboration, workshops, demonstrations, training and high-stakes delivery

EDUCATION

BFA, Computer Art - School of Visual Arts, New York, NY

Additional: Immersive experience instruction and curriculum development; School of Visual Arts thesis judging; international creative/technology education and mentorship.